

Recipes for shady sites

LEAFY EDIBLES FOR PART SHADE

Lettuces tend to bolt quickly in bright sun, while thriving in a cool spot in part shade. Swiss chard will also adapt to some shade, and varieties with colorful stems make pretty partners for green and purple lettuces.

Dot pot marigolds between your leafy crops for spots of orange or yellow to create a border that looks as good as it tastes. Guard against slugs, especially when the lettuces are young, and keep the border well-watered.

Plant list

- 1 Swiss chard
- 2 Pot marigold
- 3 Purple lettuce
- 4 Purple frilly-leaved lettuce ('Lollo Rossa')
- 5 Green lettuce ('cut and-come-again' variety)



FOLIAGE TEXTURES FOR CLAY SOIL

This rich mix of foliage plants would be perfect for a shady site just beyond a tree canopy and needs few flowers to create a spectacular effect. Combine large-leaved hostas and pigsqueaks to smother the soil, and the majestic ostrich fern, for additional height and texture toward the back of the border. Flowers will appear from spring to summer, starting with the pigsqueaks and the acid-yellow blooms of the marsh euphorbia, and continuing with pale lilac hosta blooms as summer progresses, and tall stems of yellow leopard plant flowers, which appear later in the season. Take precautions against slug damage to ensure the hostas are not shredded.

Plant list

- 1 *Bergenia purpurascens*
- 2 *Hosta sieboldiana* var. *elegans*
- 3 *Polygonatum x hybridum*
- 4 *Euphorbia palustris*
- 5 *Ligularia dentata*
- 6 *Ligularia stenocephala*
- 7 *Matteuccia struthiopteris*
- 8 *Darmera peltata*

